

Title: Let’ Take Action Against Climate Change

Ladies and gentlemen,

Have you noticed how strange our weather has become? Typhoons in Taiwan are getting stronger, and droughts seem to stretch on forever. In 2021, we faced the worst drought in 50 years. Over a million households were affected, crops dried up, and reservoirs nearly ran out of water. Was this just bad luck? No—this is climate change knocking on our door, and it’s knocking louder than ever.

Across the globe, extreme weather is becoming the new normal. NASA scientists have confirmed that global temperatures have risen by 1.1°C since the late 19th century. That might not sound like much, but it’s enough to supercharge hurricanes, cause sea levels to rise, and trigger deadly floods. Just last year, floods in Pakistan displaced 33 million people. These aren’t just numbers —these are people whose lives were turned upside down.

Here in Taiwan, we’ve pledged to hit net-zero emissions by 2050. But let’s be honest, it won’t be easy. To make real change, we must think bigger. One powerful solution is the circular economy. Unlike our current “take-make-throw away” model, the circular economy is about reusing, repairing, and recycling materials. This reduces waste, saves resources, and lowers carbon emissions. For example, if companies design phones that can be easily fixed, fewer phones end up in landfills.

Another key strategy is smart national energy policies. Governments must move away from fossil fuels like coal and oil, and invest in clean energy like solar, wind, and hydropower. Countries like Denmark already get over half of their electricity from wind. Taiwan is also working on this by building more solar farms and encouraging energy-saving habits.

But this isn't just about government policies—it's about us, too. We can all make a difference. Ride a bike or take public transport instead of driving. Cars alone contribute more than 20% of the world's carbon emissions. Say no to plastic waste—Taiwan produces over 4 million tons of it every year. Turn off lights and unplug devices when they're not in use; did you know idle electronics waste about 10% of household energy? Each action may seem small, but when multiplied by millions of people, the impact is huge. If every person cuts just 1 kilogram of carbon emissions daily, we could save millions of tons of CO_2 every year.

Small actions lead to massive change. As individuals, we must embrace sustainable habits, and as nations, we must push for ambitious policies. Together, we can create a future worth living in. Every step matters, and the time to act is now.

Thank you.